

Anhima cornuta

Horned screamer

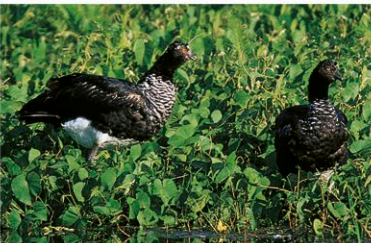


Length 33 in (84 cm)
Weight 4½–6½ lb (2–3 kg)
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Nonmigrant
Status Least concern

Location N. South America



Although related to other waterfowl, screamers have many distinctive features, including turkeylike bodies, narrow bills, and long legs ending in partly webbed feet. The largest of the 3 species in the screamer family, the horned screamer is black and white, with a remarkable slender spike, up to 4 in (10 cm) long, that curves upward and forward from its forehead. Like its relatives, it often feeds on land rather than in water. Females lay 4–6 eggs in a nest on the ground, and these take 6 weeks to hatch.



Dendrocygna eytoni

Plumed whistling duck



Length 16–23½ in (40–60 cm)
Weight 1–3¼ lb (0.5–1.5 kg)
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Partial migrant
Status Least concern

Location N. and E. Australia



Like all 8 species of whistling ducks, this species has long legs and large, webbed feet, with a netlike pattern on the ankle and heel, a characteristic that is more typical of a goose than a duck. The plumed whistling duck also has some geoselike behavioral traits: it mostly feeds on land, pulling and clipping grasses. It is believed to remain monogamous for life. The male also cares for the young.



Cygnus olor

Mute swan

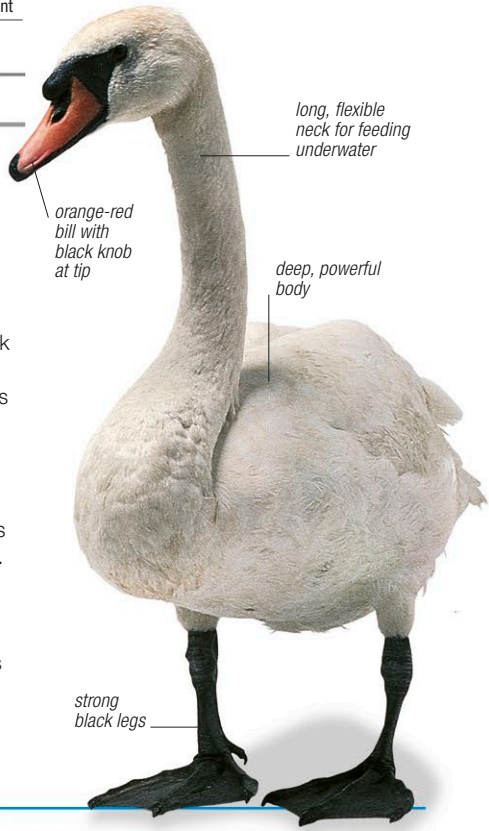


Length 5 ft (1.5 m)
Weight 26 lb (12 kg)
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Partial migrant
Status Least concern

Location North America, Europe, Africa, Asia, Australia



Originally from Europe and Central Asia, this extremely elegant bird has been introduced as an ornamental species in many other parts of the world. When young, the mute swan is grayish brown, but the adult has pure white plumage, an orange-red bill, and black legs and feet. One of the world's heaviest flying birds, it runs or paddles across the water to take off, but once airborne, is a powerful flier, making a distinctive pulsating sound with its wings. Mute swans feed mainly on water, often up-ending to reach plants and small animals in underwater mud. They mate for life, and nest by the water's edge or on small islands, making a mound of vegetation often more than 3¼ ft (1 m) across. Females lay up to 8 eggs in a clutch, and take sole charge of incubation. Once the young have hatched, both parents look after them, until they become



Cygnus atratus

Black swan



Length 3½–4½ ft (1.1–1.4 m)
Weight 13 lb (6 kg)
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Nomadic
Status Least concern

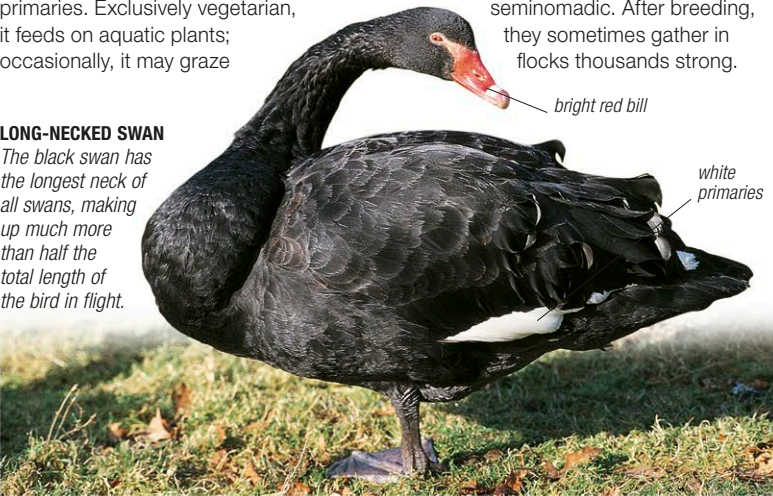
Location Australia (including Tasmania), New Zealand



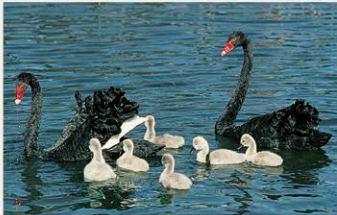
This is the only swan that is almost entirely black. The innermost flight feathers are curiously twisted, and when threatened, the swan raises these feathers and exposes the white primaries. Exclusively vegetarian, it feeds on aquatic plants; occasionally, it may graze

LONG-NECKED SWAN

The black swan has the longest neck of all swans, making up much more than half the total length of the bird in flight.



FAMILY TIES



Like other swans, this species is strictly monogamous. The male and female have a strong bond and both participate in building the nest and caring for the young.

on land. Compared to most other swans, black swans are highly sociable, and also seminomadic. After breeding, they sometimes gather in flocks thousands strong.

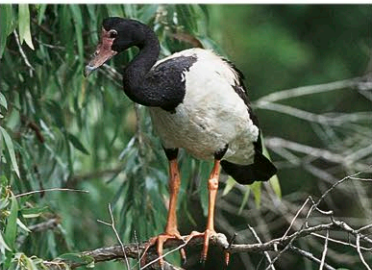
Anseranas semipalmata

Magpie goose



Length 30–35 in (75–90 cm)
Weight 6½ lb (3 kg)
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Partial migrant
Status Least concern

Location S. New Guinea, N. Australia



The only species in its family, this goselike bird is unique among waterfowl in many ways: its toes are only slightly webbed; the hind toes are unusually long, enabling it to perch easily on small branches; and it is the only waterfowl with legs so long that the ends of the feet extend beyond the tail during flight. It is also the only waterbird to form breeding groups of one male and 2 females. The male is larger, with a more distinctive bony "bump" on his crown.

Anser anser

Greylag goose



Length 30–35 in (75–90 cm)
Weight 6½–8¾ lb (3–4 kg)
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Migrant
Status Least concern

Location Europe (including Iceland), Asia



The greylag goose is the wild ancestor of barnyard geese, originally bred in Central Europe, and the basis for almost all European goose folklore. The name "greylag" derives from its gray coloration and the fact that it undertakes late migrations, or "lags" behind other geese. Males swim in a haughty posture to attract the female, and mating is often preceded by mutual head-dipping.

